

Floetry Brings Butterflies and Big Smiles to the Tiny Desk

From: NPR Music Mined: 2026-06-02 3 min read

Imagine two best friends who've made music together since they were young, and now they're performing at one of the coolest little concert spaces in the world. That's exactly what happened when Floetry the British **R&B duo** of Natalie "The Floacist" Stewart and Marsha "The Songstress" Ambrosius brought their magic to NPR's **Tiny Desk**. The pair traveled all the way from London to Philadelphia just to share their **vibe**, and boy, did they deliver. Their set was part of a special Black Music Month celebration, and it felt like a warm hug. They kicked things off with "Big Ben," a song that nods to their U.K. roots. Then came "Butterflies," a dreamy tune that Marsha co-wrote and yes, it's the same one Michael Jackson famously sang! Her voice fluttered so lightly, it really did feel like butterflies in the room. But the funniest moment came during "Say Yes" and "Getting Late." These songs are a little... steamy. The **duo** cracked up, joking that it might be too early in the day for such **sultry** tunes. The audience didn't mind one bit they were singing along and swaying with pure joy. You could see the sisterhood between Natalie and Marsha in every glance and giggle. They closed with "Floetic," their very first **single**, taking everyone back to when they were just two 20-somethings bursting onto the music scene. It was a **Tiny Desk** concert full of laughter, soul, and the kind of friendship that makes you want to grab your bestie and start a band.

Word Treasure

duo -- Two people who perform together as a team.

R&B -- A style of music that stands for rhythm and blues, known for soulful singing.

Tiny Desk -- A series of small concerts filmed in the office of the public radio network NPR.

sultry -- Something that feels warm, romantic, or a little steamy.

single -- A song that is released separately, often to promote an album.

vibe -- The feeling or mood that a place or performance gives off.

Background you need

NPR (National Public Radio, a U.S. radio network) created the Tiny Desk concert series in 2008, inviting musicians to perform right at an office desk.

Black Music Month, celebrated each June, honors the huge impact that Black musicians have had on American music and culture.

Floetry's song 'Butterflies' became even more famous when Michael Jackson (the late pop legend) included it on his 2001 album 'Invincible'.

Break it down

WHO: Natalie 'The Floacist' Stewart and Marsha 'The Songstress' Ambrosius, the duo Floetry.

WHAT: They performed a Tiny Desk concert for NPR, sharing songs and laughs.

WHERE: At the NPR Tiny Desk, a small performance space in Washington, D.C.

WHY: To take part in a Black Music Month celebration and reconnect with their fans and each other.

Why it matters

Even small, intimate concerts can show the power of friendship and music, reminding us that sharing joy with others-just like Floetry did-can make any day better.

Test what you remember

1. What is the name of the musical duo in the article?
 - (A) The Floacist & The Songstress
 - (B) Floetry
 - (C) Big Ben
 - (D) Butterfly
2. Which song did Marsha co-write that was later famous by Michael Jackson?
 - (A) Say Yes
 - (B) Getting Late
 - (C) Butterflies
 - (D) Floetic
3. What made the duo laugh during the performance?
 - (A) The audience was too quiet
 - (B) They forgot the lyrics
 - (C) They thought their songs were too steamy for the time of day
 - (D) The instruments broke
4. Which two songs did they joke were too sultry?
 - (A) Big Ben and Butterflies
 - (B) Say Yes and Getting Late
 - (C) Butterflies and Floetic
 - (D) Big Ben and Floetic
5. What city did Floetry travel from to perform at the Tiny Desk?
 - (A) New York
 - (B) London
 - (C) Atlanta
 - (D) Chicago
6. What was the name of their very first single?
 - (A) Say Yes
 - (B) Floetic
 - (C) Butterflies
 - (D) Getting Late

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: C 3: C 4: B 5: B 6: B

Questions to think about

- 1. Positive:** The performance was a joyful reunion for the duo, and fans loved the laughter and soulful singing that showed their strong bond.
- 2. Critical:** Some might say the concert was too short or that the duo hasn't created new music together recently, making it more of a nostalgic moment than a fresh one.
- 3. Neutral:** Tiny Desk concerts are meant to be intimate and casual, and this one captured the true spirit of the series.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):